

# Alpi

## User Guide

Your little companion for screenshots, screen recordings and file conversion on the Mac

Version 0.8 Beta · macOS 14 or later · made for macOS 27

turQis Labs

© 2026 turQis Labs

# Contents

**1 Welcome to Alpi . . . 4**

Requirements . . . 4

Where Alpi lives . . . 4

**2 Getting Started . . . 4**

First launch . . . 4

Permissions at a glance . . . 5

**3 Meet Alpi . . . 5**

Moving Alpi around . . . 5

Full-screen apps . . . 5

Two places to live . . . 6

The Orbit – your screenshot inbox . . . 6

**4 Capturing the Screen . . . 6**

Selecting an area . . . 7

After selecting – the action bar . . . 7

Self-timer . . . 8

Copy text and QR codes . . . 8

Scrolling capture . . . 8

**5 The Editor . . . 8**

Tools . . . 8

Style and colours . . . 9

Automatic redaction . . . 9

Frame – make it look great . . . 9

Image adjustments . . . 9

Saving and sharing . . . 10

**6 Pinned Images and History . . . 10**

Pinned images . . . 10

History . . . 10

**7 Shelf, Clipboard and Smart Actions . . . 11**

The shelf – park any file . . . 11

Smart actions . . . 11

Clipboard history . . . 11
Colour picker and QR codes . . . 12
**8 Ask Alpi, Presenting and Automation . . . 12**
Ask Alpi . . . 12
Draw on the screen . . . 12
Camera bubble . . . 12
Folder rules . . . 13
Sorting Downloads . . . 13
Shortcuts app . . . 13
Alpi's personality . . . 14
**9 Screen Recording . . . 14**
Recording options . . . 14
**10 Converting Files . . . 15**
The three wheels . . . 15
What Alpi can convert . . . 15
Office files that look like the original . . . 15
**11 The Alpi Folder and Settings . . . 16**
The Alpi folder . . . 16
Settings . . . 16
**12 Keyboard Shortcuts . . . 17**
Global . . . 17
While selecting . . . 17
Editor . . . 18
**13 Troubleshooting . . . 18**
Privacy & security . . . 18
Beta, feedback and updates . . . 19
Credits . . . 19

# 1 Welcome to Alpi

Alpi is a small, friendly companion that floats on your Mac's screen. It looks after three jobs that usually need three separate apps:

- **Capture** – screenshots of an area, a window or the whole screen, text recognition, long scrolling captures and screen recordings with sound.
- **Edit** – a full screenshot editor with arrows, text, numbered steps, blur and redaction, highlights, a beautiful frame and image adjustments.
- **Convert** – drop files on Alpi to turn images, PDFs, documents, spreadsheets, presentations, videos and audio into other formats.

Everything runs locally on your Mac. Text recognition, face detection and conversions use Apple's built-in frameworks – nothing is uploaded.

> **Note** Alpi speaks English and German and follows your Mac's language. To use a different language just for Alpi, choose it in *System Settings* › *General* › *Language & Region* › *Applications*.

## Requirements

- macOS 14 Sonoma or later (Apple silicon or Intel). Designed for macOS 27: Liquid Glass panels from macOS 26, Apple Intelligence features from macOS 26, image understanding from macOS 27.
- Optional for best Office conversions: Microsoft Word/PowerPoint, LibreOffice (free) or Pages/Keynote/Numbers.

## Where Alpi lives

Alpi has no Dock icon. You'll find it in two places:

- **The menu bar** – a small circle with two eyes. Click it for the menu: capture, settings, the Alpi folder, About and Quit.
- **On your desktop** – Alpi himself, a turquoise orb with a face. Drag him anywhere, throw him across the screen, or let him dock at the edge.

> **Tip** Press `⌃⌥A` at any time to show or hide Alpi.

# 2 Getting Started

## First launch

1. Open Alpi. It appears at the right edge of your screen and greets you.
2. macOS may ask for permission to access your **Documents** folder – Alpi stores its files in *Documents* › *Alpi*.
3. Alpi offers to **collect your macOS screenshots**. If you agree, screenshots taken with `⇧⌘3`, `⇧⌘4` or `⇧⌘5` land in Alpi's folder and appear in his Orbit instead of on your desktop. When Alpi quits, your original macOS settings are restored.
4. The first time you use Alpi's own capture (`⌃⌥S`), macOS asks for **Screen & System Audio Recording** permission. Turn Alpi on in *System Settings* › *Privacy & Security* › *Screen & System Audio Recording*, then

restart Alpi once.

## Permissions at a glance

| Permission | Needed for | When it's asked |
|---|---|---|
| Documents folder | Storing screenshots, results, videos and history | First launch |
| Screen & System Audio Recording | Alpi's own screenshots, scroll capture, screen recordings | First capture |
| Microphone | Recording your voice with a screen video | Only if you turn on “Record microphone” |
| Camera | The camera bubble | First time you show the camera bubble |
| Accessibility | Auto-scroll during a scrolling capture | Only when you press “Auto-Scroll” |
| Automation | Controlling Office apps for faithful conversions; reading the Finder selection for Ask Alpi | First time it's needed |

> **Note** If you build Alpi yourself in Xcode without a signing team, macOS may ask for permissions again after every build. Choose your team under *Signing & Capabilities* to avoid this.

# 3 Meet Alpi

Alpi has moods. He floats gently, blinks, follows your mouse with his eyes, smiles when you pet him, looks surprised when you drag him, munches new screenshots and falls asleep when nothing happens for a while. He talks to you through a small speech bubble.

## Moving Alpi around

| Action | Result |
|---|---|
| Hover over Alpi | Alpi is happy; resting a moment opens the Orbit |
| Click Alpi | Keeps the Orbit open; click again to close. If Alpi shows a “?”, the click shows his suggestion |
| Drag Alpi | Move him anywhere – also to other displays |
| Throw Alpi | Drag with some speed and let go – he glides and bounces off the edges |
| Release near the left/right edge | Alpi docks and tucks himself away when idle |
| Right-click Alpi | Menu: take a screenshot, screen video, history, open Orbit, discard all, back to the edge, hide, settings |

## Full-screen apps

In full-screen apps (videos, presentations, Xcode in full screen) Alpi gets out of the way. Move the pointer to the very top edge of the screen for a moment – or press `⌃⌥A` – and Alpi drops down below the menu bar together with your screenshots. Move away and he disappears again. New screenshots taken in full screen are caught with

a short visit.

### Two places to live

- **On the desktop**, the default: Alpi floats freely. To convert files, drag them straight onto him.
- **Only in the menu bar**: Alpi stays in the menu bar icon. Click the icon to bring him down together with your screenshots. While dragging files, press `⇧`, `⌘` or `⌃` to open the conversion wheel at your pointer. Drag Alpi out of the menu bar onto the desktop to make him live there again.

Switch between the two in the menu bar menu or in *Settings › Where does Alpi live?*

### The Orbit – your screenshot inbox

New screenshots fly into Alpi and appear as cards in a tidy column next to him – the **Orbit**. It always opens towards the middle of the screen. Up to four cards are shown; "+N more" opens the Screenshots folder.

| Action on a card | Result |
|---|---|
| Hover | A small bar appears: Copy · Copy text · Smart actions · Edit · Pin |
| Click | Copy the image |
| Double-click | Open it in the Alpi Editor |
| Drag into an app | The app gets a copy; the card stays |
| Drag into a folder or onto the desktop | The file is kept there and leaves the Orbit |
| Drag to the Trash or click × | Discard |
| Right-click | Copy, copy recognized text, edit, pin, open with Preview, show in Finder, save to desktop, discard |

> **Tip** Alpi reads the text in every new screenshot in the background, but only copies it when you click **Copy text** on a card. If you prefer the old behaviour, turn on "Offer recognized text after every screenshot" in Settings.

# 4 Capturing the Screen

Alpi has his own capture tool. All shortcuts use Control + Option, so they never clash with the macOS shortcuts `⇧⌘3` / `⇧⌘4` / `⇧⌘5`. Every capture is also available from the menu bar menu and by right-clicking Alpi.

| Shortcut | What it does |
|---|---|
| `⌃⌥S` | Capture an area or a window |
| `⌃⌥W` | Capture a window (picked by clicking, captured on its own without background) |
| `⌃⌥F` | Capture the entire screen under the pointer |
| `⌃⌥T` | Copy text from an area (also reads QR codes and barcodes) |
| `⌃⌥L` | Scrolling capture of a long page |
| `⌃⌥R` | Start or stop a screen recording |

| Shortcut | What it does |
|---|---|
| ⌃⌥**P** | Pin the newest screenshot to the screen |
| ⌃⌥**H** | Open the history |
| ⌃⌥**V** | Clipboard history |
| ⌃⌥**C** | Pick a colour from the screen |
| ⌃⌥**K** | Ask Alpi |
| ⌃⌥**D** | Draw on the screen |
| ⌃⌥**A** | Show or hide Alpi |

## Selecting an area

After ⌃⌥**S** the screen freezes, so menus and tooltips stay exactly as they were. A short hint appears at the top.

- **Drag** to select an area. A magnifier next to the pointer shows the pixels, their coordinates and the colour (hex).
- **Click** a window to select it. Alpi then captures that window on its own – without the desktop behind it, even if parts were covered.
- Press **F** or ⏎ (with nothing selected) for the whole screen.
- Pick an **aspect ratio** at the top: Free, 1:1, 4:3, 3:2, 16:9 or 9:16.
- Hold ⇧ for a square, ⌥ to draw from the centre.
- Fine-tune with the handles or the arrow keys ( ⇧ = 10 points, ⌥ + arrows = resize).
- **Esc** cancels at any time.

## After selecting – the action bar

A small bar appears below your selection:

| Button | Key | Result |
|---|---|---|
| Edit *(“Bearbeiten”)* | **E** | Open the capture in the Alpi Editor |
| Copy *(“Kopieren”)* | ⌘**C** | Copy to the clipboard |
| Save *(“Sichern”)* | ⌘**S** | Save as PNG into *Alpi* › *Screenshots* (appears in the Orbit) |
| Text *(“Text kopieren”)* | **T** | Recognize the text and copy it |
| Pin *(“Anheften”)* | **P** | Float the capture above all windows |
| Done *(“Fertig”)* | ⏎ or double-click | Quick action – by default *copy and save* (change in Settings) |

> **Tip** Captures are saved with the correct Retina resolution, so they paste at the right size. Alpi himself never appears in your captures.

### Self-timer

Need to open a menu first? In the menu bar menu choose **Self-Timer** and pick 3, 5 or 10 seconds – for an area or the whole screen. A large countdown appears; **Esc** cancels it.

### Copy text and QR codes

Press ⌃⌥T and drag over any text – even text in images, videos or apps that don't let you select it. Alpi copies it to the clipboard and shows a preview. If the area contains a QR code with a link, Alpi offers to open it.

### Scrolling capture

1. Press ⌃⌥L and select the part of the window that scrolls (or click the window).
2. A dashed frame marks the area and a small panel appears next to it.
3. Scroll down slowly. Alpi stitches the pieces together and shows a live preview and the current height.
4. Click **Done**. The long image is saved and opens in the editor.

Sticky headers and footers (toolbars, cookie banners) are detected and appear only once. If you scroll too fast, Alpi asks you to scroll back a little.

> **Tip** Click **Auto-Scroll** to let Alpi scroll for you. It stops by itself at the bottom. This needs the Accessibility permission; keep the pointer over the area.

# 5 The Editor

Open the editor with **Edit** in the action bar, by double-clicking an Orbit card, from the history or by double-clicking a pinned image. The window has a toolbar at the top, the canvas in the middle, an inspector on the right and actions at the bottom. The inspector has three panels: **Annotate**, **Beautify** and **Image**.

### Tools

| Key | Tool | How it works |
|---|---|---|
| V | Select | Click to select, drag to move, drag the round handles to reshape. Double-click text to edit it |
| A | Arrow | Five styles: arrow, double arrow, wedge, curved (drag the middle handle to bend), open |
| L | Line | Straight line; ⇧ snaps to 45° |
| R | Rectangle | Outline, half-transparent or solid fill; square, round or very round corners |
| O | Ellipse | Same fills as the rectangle; ⇧ draws a circle |
| T | Text | Click and type. Optional coloured background. Esc or ⌘⏎ finishes |
| N | Number | Click to place the next step number (1, 2, 3 …). Drag to give it a pointer |
| S | Stamp | Emoji stamps (thumbs up, check mark, cross, warning, idea, …) – pick one in the inspector |
| P | Pencil | Freehand drawing, smoothed |

| Key | Tool | How it works |
|---|---|---|
| **H** | Highlighter | Transparent marker that doesn't hide the text; ⇧ draws a straight line |
| **X** | Obscure | Black out (default), pixelate or blur an area |
| **G** | Spotlight | Darkens everything outside the marked areas |
| **Z** | Loupe | A round magnifier that enlarges what's beneath 2× |
| **M** | Measure | Shows the distance in pixels |
| **I** | Colour picker | Click the image to pick a colour; the hex value is copied |
| **C** | Crop | Drag the new frame, move it, apply with ⏎; ⇧ = square |

## Style and colours

- Choose a colour from the palette (keys **1** – **8**) or any colour with the colour well.
- Line width S, M, L or XL; text, number and stamp size S, M, L or XL.
- Changing a style while an item is selected changes that item.
- ⌫ deletes, **⌘D** duplicates, arrow keys nudge (⇧ = 10 px), “To front” brings an item to the top.
- **⌘Z** undo, **⇧⌘Z** redo – as many steps as you like.
- **⌘V** pastes an image (as a movable item) or text.
- Zoom with the trackpad, **⌘+** / **⌘–**, **⌘0** for 100 % and **⌘9** to fit.

## Automatic redaction

In the **Annotate** panel, **Personal data** finds and blacks out e-mail addresses, phone numbers, IBANs, card numbers, IP addresses, access keys, tokens and passwords. **Faces** pixelates all faces. You can move, resize or delete every redaction afterwards.

> **Note** Text is blacked out completely on purpose: pixelated text can sometimes be reconstructed. Always check the result before sharing sensitive images.

## Frame – make it look great

Switch on **Beautify** in the **Beautify** panel to place your screenshot on a background – perfect for social media, docs and slides.

- **Background:** nine gradients, a solid colour, or none (transparent).
- **Padding**, **corner radius** and **shadow** with sliders.
- **Window frame:** a light or dark title bar with the three traffic-light buttons.
- Alpi remembers your last look for the next image (switched off until you turn it on).

## Image adjustments

- In the **Image** panel: brightness, contrast, saturation and sharpness.
- Filters: Vivid, Warm, Cool, Black & White, Noir, Faded, Chrome, Instant and Processed.
- Rotate 90° and flip horizontally – annotations move along.

- **Reset** returns to the original.

## Saving and sharing

| Button | Result |
|---|---|
| Copy text *(“Text kopieren”)* | Recognizes all text (and QR codes) in the image and copies it |
| Pin *(“Anheften”)* | Floats the finished image above all windows |
| Copy `⌘C` | Copies the finished image, including frame |
| Save `⌘S` | Saves a PNG into *Alpi* › *Screenshots*. An image from the Orbit is updated in place – the untouched original stays in the history |
| Done *(“Fertig”)* | Saves (if needed) and closes |

> **Tip** Your annotations stay editable. Reopen the image from the Orbit or the history and every arrow and text box is still there.

# 6 Pinned Images and History

## Pinned images

A pinned image floats above all windows on every Space – handy for copying numbers, comparing designs or keeping instructions in view.

| Action | Result |
|---|---|
| Drag | Move the image |
| Scroll | Zoom in and out around the pointer |
| `⌥` + scroll | Change the opacity |
| Double-click | Open in the editor |
| `⌘C` | Copy |
| `Esc` or the × (on hover) | Close |
| Right-click | Copy, edit, original size, opacity 100/80/60/40 %, close |

Pin the newest screenshot from the Orbit with `⌃⌥P`. Close all pinned images from the menu bar menu.

## History

Open the history with `⌃⌥H`. It shows your recent captures as thumbnails. Each entry keeps the original image together with its annotations, so you can continue editing at any time.

- Double-click an entry to open it in the editor.
- Right-click to pin it, show it in the Finder or delete it.
- By default Alpi keeps the last 40 captures (5–200, see Settings). **Clear history** removes everything.

# 7 Shelf, Clipboard and Smart Actions

## The shelf – park any file

Collecting files from different folders? Drag them onto Alpi, switch to the **Actions** wheel and drop them on **Park**. Alpi carries them in his Orbit – across desktops and into full-screen apps – until you drag them out where you need them. The files stay where they are; Alpi only keeps a reference.

- Drag a single card out, or drag the turquoise stack chip in the Orbit header to take **all parked files at once**.
- Hover a parked card for Copy (as a file), Open and Show in Finder.
- Right-click Alpi › **Clear shelf** to empty it.

## Smart actions

Hover a screenshot card and click the sparkles button. Alpi looks at the image – only now, never on its own – and offers what fits:

- **Dates** → create a calendar event (opens an .ics in Calendar).
- **Addresses** → show in Maps · **Phone numbers** → call · **Links and e-mail addresses** → open.
- **QR codes and barcodes** → open or copy the content.
- **Tables** → save as an Excel file or copy for Excel/Numbers.
- Copy all text, or turn a found link into a new QR code.
- With Apple Intelligence: **Rename with Apple Intelligence** gives the file a meaningful name; on macOS 27 **Describe** explains what the image shows.

## Clipboard history

Press `⌃⌥V` for the last 60 things you copied – texts, links, images and files. Type to search, use the arrow keys and press `⏎` to paste straight into the app you're working in (this needs the Accessibility permission; without it, Alpi just copies).

| Key | Action |
|---|---|
| `⏎` | Paste the selected entry |
| `⌘C` | Copy only |
| `⌘R` | Make a QR code |
| `⌘P` | Park it (text becomes a note, images a card) |
| `⌘⌫` | Remove the entry |
| `Esc` | Close |

> **Note** The history lives only in memory and is gone when Alpi quits. Content marked as confidential, anything copied from password managers and anything copied while a password field is active is never recorded. By default the history is cleared when you lock the screen and entries are forgotten after 24 hours – see *Privacy & security* below.

## Colour picker and QR codes

- `⌃⌥C` shows the macOS magnifier. Click any pixel on screen – the hex value is copied, and Alpi offers the SwiftUI code too.
- **QR code from clipboard** (right-click Alpi or the menu bar menu) turns a copied link or text into a crisp QR code card in the Orbit.

# 8 Ask Alpi, Presenting and Automation

## Ask Alpi

Press `⌃⌥K` (or right-click Alpi › **Ask Alpi**) and type what you want in plain words. Alpi always understands simple commands in German and English:

- “Capture window”, “whole screen in 5 seconds”, “copy text”, “scrolling capture”, “record video”
- “Selected images to JPG”, “merge selected PDFs”, “park selected files” – works on the files selected in the Finder
- “QR code for https://…”, “pick a colour”, “clipboard”, “history”, “draw on screen”, “camera”
- “Sort my Downloads”, “sort a folder”, “undo the sort”

With **Apple Intelligence** (macOS 26 or later) Alpi also understands free requests, multi-step commands (“convert the selected images to PDF and park them”) and answers questions. On **macOS 27** Alpi can look at the screenshot itself: ask “What's on the screenshot?”, “summarize this” or “translate that”. Everything runs with Apple's on-device model; nothing leaves your Mac.

## Draw on the screen

Press `⌃⌥D` to draw directly on top of everything – great for presentations, video calls and screen recordings.

| Key | Action |
|---|---|
| `P` `H` `A` `R` `O` `G` | Pen, highlighter, arrow, rectangle, ellipse, spotlight |
| `1` – `8` | Colours |
| `F` | Fade strokes after a few seconds, like a laser pointer |
| `⌫` / `⌘Z` | Undo |
| `C` | Clear everything |
| `Esc` | Finish |

Your drawings appear in screenshots and screen recordings.

## Camera bubble

Show your camera as a round bubble with a turquoise ring (right-click Alpi › **Show camera bubble**). Drag it anywhere, scroll to resize, hover and click × to close. Turn on “Show camera bubble while recording” in Settings to add it to every screen video automatically.

## Folder rules

In *Settings › Folder rules* Alpi can look after folders for you:

- **Convert new files** – e.g. HEIC photos in Downloads → JPG (any target from the wheels works).
- **Park new files** – new downloads land on Alpi's shelf.
- **Clean up old files** – e.g. screenshots older than 7 days go to the Trash (never deleted permanently).

## Sorting Downloads

Is your Downloads folder a mess? Ask Alpi (“Sort my Downloads”), or choose **Sort Folder › Sort Downloads…** in the menu bar menu or by right-clicking Alpi. Alpi sorts the files into subfolders by type:

| Folder | Contains |
|---|---|
| Images | Photos, screenshots, graphics |
| Videos | Movies and screen recordings |
| Audio | Music, voice memos, podcasts |
| Documents | PDF, Word, Pages, Excel, Numbers, PowerPoint, Keynote, text |
| Archives | ZIP, RAR, 7z, tar … |
| Installers | DMG, PKG and apps |
| Code | Source code, JSON, HTML, scripts |
| Other | Everything else |

- Before anything moves, Alpi shows how many files go where and asks for your OK.
- Only files directly in the folder are sorted – your own subfolders stay as they are. Downloads that are still running and files from the last minute are left alone.
- Nothing is deleted. **Undo Last Sort** (bubble, menu or “undo the sort”) puts every file back where it was.
- **Sort Another Folder…** works the same way for any folder, e.g. your Desktop.

**Automatically:** in *Settings › Folder Sorting* you can let Alpi sort new downloads by itself – right away, after 1 hour (default) or after a day. With a wait, fresh downloads stay where your browser expects them, so “Show in Finder” keeps working. **Leave unopened downloads** keeps files you haven't opened yet in Downloads (for up to 7 days). Every automatic sort is announced with an Undo button. Don't need sorting at all? Switch off **Offer folder sorting** – the menu items disappear and Ask Alpi won't sort.

## Shortcuts app

Alpi's actions are available as building blocks in the Shortcuts app, in Spotlight and via Siri: take a screenshot, start/stop a screen video, recognize text in an image, create a QR code, convert files, park files, sort Downloads and Ask Alpi.

## Alpi's personality

Alpi lives with your day: a nightcap from 10 pm (and he dozes off sooner at night), sunglasses on Friday afternoons and weekends, a Santa hat in December, confetti and a party hat for every 100th screenshot, a good-morning greeting – and after two hours without a break a gentle reminder. Everything can be switched off under *Settings › Alpi's character*.

# 9 Screen Recording

1. Press `⌃⌥R` (or choose **Screen Recording** in the menu).
2. Drag an area, click a window, or press `F` for the whole screen.
3. A 3-2-1 countdown starts, then Alpi records. A red dashed frame marks the area (it is not recorded).
4. Stop with the red **0:42** in the menu bar or press `⌃⌥R` again.

A result window opens where you can:

- **Play** the video,
- **Trim** it – drag the yellow handles and confirm,
- remove the sound,
- turn it into an animated GIF,
- **Copy** the file to paste it into Mail, Slack or Messages,
- show it in the Finder, or move it to the Trash.

## Recording options

| Setting | Description |
|---|---|
| Format | MP4 video or GIF (the GIF is created automatically after recording) |
| Frames per second | 30 or 60 |
| Record system audio | Sound from your apps (Alpi's own sounds are excluded) |
| Record microphone | Adds your voice as a second audio track |
| Show clicks | A turquoise ring for left clicks and an amber ring for right clicks |
| Show pointer | Records the mouse pointer |
| 3-second countdown | Gives you a moment before recording starts |

> **Note** Videos are saved in *Alpi › Recordings*. System audio and microphone are stored as two separate tracks; some players only play the first one. If you quit Alpi while recording, it finishes the file first.

# 10 Converting Files

Drag one or more files onto Alpi. He grows and shows the possible conversions in his belly. Drop the files on a field to start, or on his face to cancel. Alpi shows a progress ring while working and says *Done* with a **Show in Finder** button.

## The three wheels

| Key while dragging | Wheel | Contents |
|---|---|---|
| ⇧ | Convert | Target formats for the file type |
| ⌘ | Tools | Resize, compress, rotate, merge, split, … |
| ⌃ | Actions | AirDrop, copy path, Terminal, copy/move to …, show in Finder |

On the desktop, press the key while the files hover over Alpi (or click a tab) to switch wheels. In menu-bar mode, pressing the key while dragging opens the wheel right at your pointer; release on a field to start, in the middle to cancel.

## What Alpi can convert

| Files | Possible results |
|---|---|
| Images (PNG, JPG, HEIC, TIFF, GIF, BMP) | PNG, JPG, HEIC, TIFF, GIF, BMP, PDF · resize, compress, rotate, flip, remove background, recognize text, strip metadata, several images → one PDF |
| PDF | PNG, JPG, TIFF (per page), TXT, RTF, DOCX, HTML · merge, split pages, rotate |
| Documents (DOCX, RTF, TXT, Markdown, HTML, ODT) | PDF, DOCX, RTF, TXT, HTML, ODT |
| Spreadsheets (XLSX, CSV, TSV, ODS; XLS and Numbers with LibreOffice/Numbers) | XLSX, CSV, TSV, JSON, HTML, PDF, Markdown – several sheets become one CSV each; German semicolon CSV is detected |
| Presentations (PPTX, PPT, Keynote, ODP) | PDF, PNG, JPG (per slide) – requires PowerPoint, Keynote or LibreOffice |
| Video | MP4, MOV, GIF, M4A · without sound, 720p, still frame |
| Audio | M4A, WAV, AIFF, CAF |
| Any files | ZIP and unzip |

## Office files that look like the original

Alpi's built-in conversion handles text and simple formatting. For DOCX → PDF with tables, images, headers and exact layout, Alpi uses a real Office app if one is installed. Choose the engine in *Settings › Converting Office files*:

| Engine | Converts | Note |
|---|---|---|
| Microsoft Word / PowerPoint | DOCX, DOC, RTF, PPTX → PDF | macOS asks once whether Alpi may control the app |
| LibreOffice (free) | DOCX, DOC, ODT, PPTX, ODP, XLSX, XLS, ODS → PDF; XLS → XLSX | Runs invisibly, no prompt |

| Engine | Converts | Note |
|---|---|---|
| Pages / Keynote / Numbers | Pages, Keynote, Numbers, DOCX, PPTX, XLSX → PDF; Numbers/XLS → XLSX | macOS asks once |

**Automatic** tries Microsoft → LibreOffice → iWork → built-in.

> **Note** MP3 output and exotic video formats (MKV, WebM, AVI) are not supported yet. Microsoft Word may ask once to grant access to the output folder.

# 11 The Alpi Folder and Settings

## The Alpi folder

Everything Alpi creates lives in one place – by default *~/Documents/Alpi*. You can move it in Settings.

| Folder | Contents |
|---|---|
| Screenshots | Your captures and the macOS screenshots Alpi collects |
| Converted | All conversion results (optionally saved next to the original instead) |
| Recordings | Screen recordings and GIFs |
| History | History: original images, annotations and previews |

## Settings

Open Settings from the menu bar menu, or press `⌘,` while an Alpi window is in front.

| Section | Options |
|---|---|
| Where does Alpi live? *(“Wo wohnt Alpi?”)* | Desktop or menu bar · bring Alpi back to the edge · hide in full-screen apps · invisible in screenshots and screen sharing |
| Capture & edit *(“Aufnehmen & Bearbeiten”)* | Turn the `⌃⌥` shortcuts on/off · what Return does after selecting (copy and save, open editor, save only, copy only) · always save every capture · include pointer · shutter sound · history length |
| Screen video *(“Bildschirmvideo”)* | MP4 or GIF · 30/60 fps · system audio · microphone · show clicks · show pointer · countdown |
| Alpi folder *(“Alpi-Ordner”)* | Location, open in Finder, change, reset · save results next to the original |
| Screenshots | Collect macOS screenshots |
| Converting Office files *(“Office-Dateien umwandeln”)* | Automatic, Microsoft Office, LibreOffice, Pages/Keynote/Numbers or built-in |
| System | Launch at login *(“Bei der Anmeldung starten”)* |

# 12 Keyboard Shortcuts

## Global

| Shortcut | Action |
|---|---|
| ⌃⌥S | Capture area or window |
| ⌃⌥W | Capture window |
| ⌃⌥F | Capture whole screen |
| ⌃⌥T | Copy text from area |
| ⌃⌥L | Scrolling capture |
| ⌃⌥R | Start/stop screen recording |
| ⌃⌥P | Pin newest screenshot |
| ⌃⌥H | History |
| ⌃⌥V | Clipboard history |
| ⌃⌥C | Pick a colour from the screen |
| ⌃⌥K | Ask Alpi |
| ⌃⌥D | Draw on the screen |
| ⌃⌥A | Show/hide Alpi |
| – | Sort Downloads (no default – assign your own) |

**Note** These are the defaults. In *Settings › Keyboard Shortcuts* you can give every action your own shortcut: click the field and press the new combination (with , or – function keys work on their own). removes a shortcut, the arrow button restores the default. If another app already uses a combination, Alpi tells you right there. Menus always show your current shortcuts.

## While selecting

| Key | Action |
|---|---|
| Drag / click | Select area / window |
| ⇧ / ⌥ | Square / from the centre |
| Arrow keys | Move the selection ( ⇧ = 10 pt, ⌥ = resize) |
| F | Whole screen |
| E ⌘C ⌘S T P | Edit, copy, save, text, pin |
| ⏎ / double-click | Quick action |
| Esc | Cancel |

## Editor

| Key | Action |
|---|---|
| V A L R O T N S | Select, arrow, line, rectangle, ellipse, text, number, stamp |
| P H X G Z M I C | Pencil, highlighter, obscure, spotlight, loupe, measure, colour picker, crop |
| 1 – 8 | Palette colours |
| ⌘Z ⇧⌘Z | Undo / redo |
| ⌫ ⌘D | Delete / duplicate |
| ⌘C ⌘V ⌘S | Copy image / paste / save |
| ⌘+ ⌘– ⌘0 ⌘9 | Zoom in / out / 100 % / fit |
| ⏎ Esc | Apply crop or edit text / deselect, cancel |

# 13 Troubleshooting

| Problem | Solution |
|---|---|
| Captures are black or only show the wallpaper | Allow Alpi under *Privacy & Security* › *Screen & System Audio Recording*, then quit and reopen Alpi. |
| A ⌃⌥ shortcut does nothing | Another app already uses it. Alpi skips shortcuts that are taken – use the menu bar menu instead, or free the shortcut in the other app. |
| Alpi is gone | Press ⌃⌥A, or use the menu bar icon › “Bring Alpi back to the edge”. In full-screen apps Alpi hides on purpose (see Settings). |
| Scrolling capture says “Too fast” | Scroll back a little and continue more slowly, or use Auto-Scroll. |
| Auto-Scroll doesn't scroll | Allow Alpi under *Privacy & Security* › *Accessibility* and keep the pointer over the area. |
| No microphone in the video | Allow Alpi under *Privacy & Security* › *Microphone* and turn on “Record microphone”. |
| DOCX → PDF loses layout | Install LibreOffice (free) or use Word/Pages, and set the Office engine to Automatic. |
| “Alpi may not control the Office app” | Allow it under *Privacy & Security* › *Automation* › *Alpi*. |
| macOS screenshots still land on the desktop | Turn on “Collect macOS screenshots” in Settings. |

## Privacy & security

Alpi works entirely on your Mac. It does not collect analytics and uploads nothing. The only connection it makes on its own is a daily check on GitHub for a new version (Settings › Privacy & Security, can be turned off); it sends nothing about you or your files.

Text recognition, face detection, redaction, Apple Intelligence and all conversions use Apple frameworks (Vision, Core Image, PDFKit, AVFoundation, ScreenCaptureKit, Foundation Models) or the Office app you chose.

Settings › **Privacy & Security** controls what Alpi keeps:

- **History** – kept for 30 days by default (1, 7, 30, 90 days or unlimited) and can be deleted at any time.
- **Redacted images** – once you black something out in the editor and save, the history keeps only the redacted version. Turn on “keep originals of redacted images” if you want to re-edit the redaction later.
- **Clipboard history** – cleared when the screen locks, entries forgotten after 1, 8 or 24 hours, plus your own list of apps Alpi should ignore.
- **Shortcuts app** – a shortcut that captures the whole screen or starts a recording asks for your OK first, unless you allow it permanently.

## Beta, feedback and updates

This is a free public beta. Found a bug or have an idea? Use **Send Feedback** in the menu bar menu or by right-clicking Alpi: it opens a GitHub issue with your Alpi and macOS version filled in, or an email if you prefer. When a new version is out, Alpi shows a bubble; **Check for Updates…** checks right away. Download the new version from *github.com/turqislabs/alpi* or *turqislabs.netlify.app/alpi* and replace the app in Applications – settings, history and screenshots stay.

A few safeguards work on their own:

- Links found in screenshots or QR codes open only if they are web, mail or phone links. Look-alike characters, a hidden “user@” part or a bare IP address trigger a warning that shows the full address.
- Folder rules don't open Office documents downloaded from the internet automatically – Alpi asks first.
- Temporary files from the Shortcuts app and calendar events are removed after an hour and when Alpi quits.
- File names and folder paths are not written to the system log in readable form.

## Credits

Alpi is made by **turQis Labs**. Parts of the screenshot collection are adapted from *Tendedero* by Alejandro Buján (MIT licence). The capture and editor features were inspired by the feature list of *macshot*; they were written from scratch without using any of its code.